

WINTER SOLDIER

The American hero destroyed and rebuilt

WINTER SOLDIER

FACTFILE

REAL NAME

James Buchanan Barnes

OCCUPATION

Assassin, spy

BASE

Russia

HEIGHT

5 ft 9 in

WEIGHT

260 lbs

EYES

Brown

HAIR

Brown

FIRST APPEARANCE

(as Bucky Barnes) *Captain America Comics* #1 (March, 1941), (as Winter Soldier) *Captain America* #1 (April 2007)

The Winter Soldier is a trained assassin and spy. His bionic left arm grants him superhuman strength.

POWERS

Unlike when he was Captain America's sidekick Bucky, the Winter Soldier regularly uses guns.

ESSENTIAL STORYLINES

- **Captain America** #1 The Winter Soldier kills the Red Skull.
- **Captain America** #8-9, 11-14 Captain America confronts the Winter Soldier and brings him to his senses.
- **Captain America** #31-33 The Winter Soldier comes in from the cold after the death of Captain America.

In World War II, young BUCKY BARNES served as CAPTAIN AMERICA's sidekick. Toward the end of the war, the pair clashed with BARON ZEMO and hopped on a drone plane filled with explosives. Captain America watched the plane explode seconds after he fell off it, and he awakened decades later—having been frozen in a block of ice—believing he'd watched his friend die.

A COLD-WAR SOLDIER

Bucky lost his left arm in the explosion, but the cold waters into which he fell preserved him until a Soviet submarine found and rescued him. Taken to Moscow, he awoke with amnesia and a crude bionic arm replacing his missing limb.

General Vasily Karpov, who had fought alongside Captain America and Bucky in the war, took advantage of this opportunity to brainwash Bucky into becoming the Winter Soldier, a coldly efficient assassin and spy. Because of his strong will, though, his mind kept trying to break through his programming, so Karpov kept Bucky in suspended animation between missions. Each time the Soviets revived him, they reinforced his brainwashing and upgraded his bionics.

Barnes's bionic arm can be detached when necessary.



COSMIC CUBE

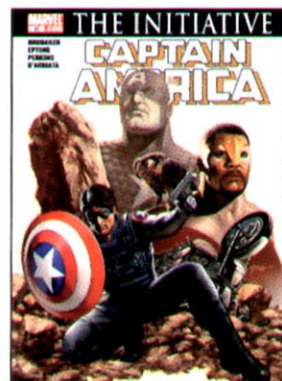
This went on for decades until Karpov died and his protégé General Aleksander LUKIN took over the Winter Soldier program. Lukin used Bucky to kill the RED SKRULL with a sniper's bullet and steal the Skull's newly made Cosmic Cube. Under Lukin's orders, Bucky also killed NOMAD and launched an attack on Philadelphia designed to charge the Cube. Captain America eventually got his hands on the Cube and used it to restore Bucky's memories. Afterward, Bucky disappeared and began hunting for Lukin.

BACK IN THE USA

Together with Captain America, Bucky saved London from a giant Nazi robot Lukin unleashed. During the CIVIL WAR (see pp. 84-5), Nick FURY—no longer with SHIELD—recruited Bucky

to work as an undercover operative. Returning to America, he fought alongside the YOUNG AVENGERS, NAMOR, and WOLVERINE.

After Captain America's death, Bucky managed to steal his old friend's shield from SHIELD's custody. The Black Widow—with whom he'd had a relationship years before—tried to stop him but failed. Later, Bucky battled IRON MAN—who had taken over as the director of SHIELD—to a draw, after which Iron Man offered him Captain America's costume to go with the shield. Knowing that this was what his friend would have wanted, Bucky accepted on two conditions: that SHIELD would clean his mind of all possible brainwashing and that he would answer only to himself. **MF**



After Captain America's death, Barnes stole his shield from SHIELD.



With his training and cybernetics, Barnes could take on Super Heroes and win.